

Somaiyah Hafeez

Data Journalist · Investigative Reporter

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Finalist, Young Journalist of the Year Award 2024 · Thomson Foundation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data and News Reporter, Reach Plc

September 2025–Present

- Introduced data reporting to the newsroom — mapping NYC mayoral election results, analyzing ICE arrest data across NYC, Chicago and the U.S., and **visualizing maps and charts** to make stories more engaging.
- Writes **breaking news and enterprise features** for Mirror US, Express US, and Irish Star across beats including the 2025 Mayoral election, the Trump administration's ICE crackdown, the Russia-Ukraine war, the U.S. measles outbreak, and conflicts in Sudan.

Freelance Journalist

May 2021–July 2024

- Authored **50+ longform and feature stories** for international outlets including [The Guardian](#), [The Diplomat](#), [New Lines Magazine](#), [The New Humanitarian](#), and Dawn.
- Investigated [enforced disappearances in Balochistan](#), the [2022 Pakistan floods](#), [resurgence of militancy](#), and Pakistan's economic crisis — leveraging **news-gathering skills and social media OSINT** to verify information quickly.
- Reported on [Afghan refugees](#), [climate-resilient housing](#), Pakistan's [transgender community](#), and [gender-based violence](#).
- Fixer for a Dutch documentary team reporting on climate change and Pakistan's political landscape.

Media Fellow, Asia Pacific Forum on Women, Law and Development (APWLD)

Aug. 2023–Aug. 2024

- Selected as Pakistan fellow for APWLD's Media and Visual Journalism Fellowship on Militarism, Peace and Women's Human Rights; produced investigative stories on enforced disappearances and their impact on women.

EDUCATION

Columbia University Graduate School of Journalism

Aug. 2024–Aug. 2025

M.S. Data Journalism

- Reported on the MTA's [fare-free bus service program](#) in Harlem, a community fight against [artificial turf fields in Inwood](#), and [community board meetings](#).
- Contributed to a [Columbia Journalism Review investigation](#) analyzing Courier Newsroom's political ad spending via Meta Ad Library.
- Built **responsive data stories using Python, pandas, and Adobe Illustrator/ai2html** on [missing persons in Balochistan](#) and [USAID funding shifts](#).
- Developed investigative and OSINT methodologies in conflict reporting.
- Reported a 5,000-word data-driven investigation on the Trump administration's impact on South Asian and immigrant communities across NYC.

National University of Sciences and Technology (NUST)

Graduated 2023

B.S. Physics · President's Gold Medal for Highest CGPA

AWARDS

- Humanitarian Reporting Award 2023, ICRC-CEJ
- Finalist, Young Journalist of the Year 2024, Thomson Foundation
- Honorable Mention, SOPA Awards 2025
- Honorable Mention, Solutions Journalism Network 2024

SKILLS

- Analysis:** Python, Pandas, R, SQL, Excel
- Scraping:** BeautifulSoup, Playwright, Selenium
- Visualization:** Datawrapper, ggplot, Flourish, Adobe Illustrator/ai2html
- Web:** GitHub, HTML/CSS
- Reporting:** FOIA, OSINT, interviewing, public records

LANGUAGES

Balochi (native) · Urdu (fluent) · English (fluent)